

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1069

By Moon

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Ronald S. Coffin for his contributions to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Blount County native Ronald S. Coffin, a highly respected member of his community who has dedicated himself to improving the quality of life for his fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, born on August 23, 1947, Mr. Coffin grew up in Maryville and attended W.J. Hale School; on September 3, 1963, six days after the "March on Washington," led by Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., he became one of the first students to integrate Maryville High School; and

WHEREAS, a Vietnam War veteran, he served his country valiantly as a member of the United States Army from March 1968 to November 1971; his overseas tours also included South Korea and Taiwan; and

WHEREAS, Ronald Coffin was duly recognized for his military service with the Army Commendation Medal, National Defense Medal, Armed Forces Expeditionary Medal, Vietnam Service Medal, Vietnam Campaign Medal, and Vietnam Cross of Gallantry with Palm; and

WHEREAS, in the years after his service, Mr. Coffin helped establish a post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) group for veterans in the Maryville area, allowing these individuals to meet with a Veterans Affairs therapist in Maryville instead of having to drive to Knoxville for assistance; and

WHEREAS, through his efforts to establish this local PTSD group, he has greatly improved the lives of his fellow veterans and has had a lasting impact on his community; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Coffin holds a Bachelor of Arts degree in Psychology with a minor in Black Studies from the University of Tennessee, as well as a master's degree in social work; he retired from his post of federal administrator after thirty-four years of dedicated service; and

WHEREAS, a man of abiding faith, Mr. Coffin is a member of St. Paul A.M.E. Zion Church in Maryville, where he is active in several church ministries; and

WHEREAS, Ronald Coffin is also wholly devoted to his family; he enjoys the love and support of his wife, Glenda Smith Coffin, and their five children, eighteen grandchildren, and eight great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Coffin epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly acknowledge and applaud Ronald Coffin for his dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Ronald S. Coffin of Maryville for his compassionate, devoted service to his fellow citizens, extending our best wishes for his every future success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.